

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed notes by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

(He typed these excerpts from Volume I The Conception - of the "Mystical City of God")

VOCATION TO THE RELIGIOUS LIFE.

INSTRUCTIONS GIVEN ME BY THE MOST HOLY VIRGIN MARY.
(THE CONCEPTION - MYSTICAL CITY OF GOD)

426. My daughter, the greatest happiness, which can fall to any soul in this mortal life, is that the Almighty call her to his house consecrated to his service. For by this benefit He rescues the soul from a dangerous slavery and relieves her of the vile servitude of the world, where, deprived of true liberty, she eats her bread in the sweat of the brow. Who is so dull and insipid as not to know the dangers of the worldly life, which is hampered by all the abominable and most wicked laws and customs introduced by the astuteness of the devil and the perversity of men? The better part is religious life and retirement; in it is found security, outside is a torment and a stormy sea, full of sorrow and unhappiness. Through the hardness of their heart and the total forgetfulness of themselves men do not know this truth and are not attracted by its blessings. But thou, O soul, be not deaf to the voice of the Most High. Attend and correspond to it in thy actions. I wish to remind thee, that one of the greatest snares of the demon is to counteract the call of the Lord, whenever He seeks to attract and incline the soul to a life of perfection in his service.

427.for the devils know that this act tends not only to the glory of the Lord and the joy of the holy angels, but that religious life will bring the soul to holiness and perfection. It very often happens, that they who have received the habit with earthly and human motives, are afterwards visited by divine grace, which perfects them and sets all things aright.

449. The order which religious souls should maintain in their desires should be: that they strive to be punctual in fulfilling the obligations of their vows and all the virtues, which are connected with them. Afterwards and secondarily they may engage in voluntary practices, such as are called supererogatory. This order some of the souls, who are misled by the devil to entertain an indiscreet zeal for perfection, are wont to invert; thus, while they fail seriously in the obligations of their state, they are eager to add other voluntary exercises and practices, which are usually of small use or benefit, or arise from a spirit of presumption and singularity. They secretly desire to be looked upon as distinguished in